

The four-minute rule

The engagement has measured the time it takes any conversation you are in to reach padel. The average is three minutes and fifty-one seconds. This is known as the four-minute rule.

The route varies. A chat about the weather goes through "good padel weather". A chat about the nursery fees goes through "that's two memberships". A chat about a friend's new baby goes through "never too early to get them on court". Your record is eleven seconds, set at a funeral, when the vicar mentioned that the deceased had been "a keen sportsman".

For the next week, please record every conversation that reaches padel, and how long it took. Lauren has offered to hold the stopwatch.